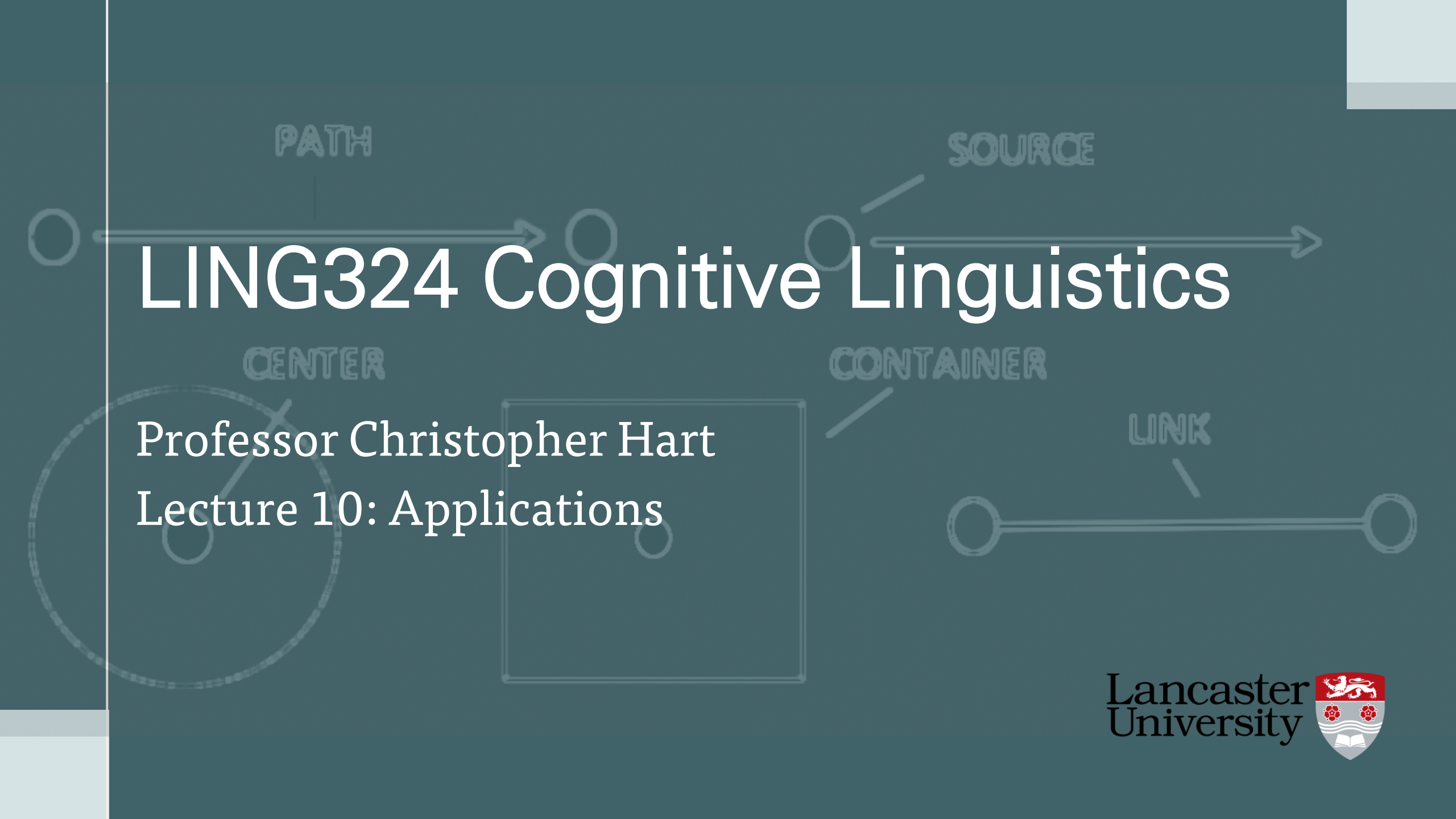




LING324 Cognitive Linguistics

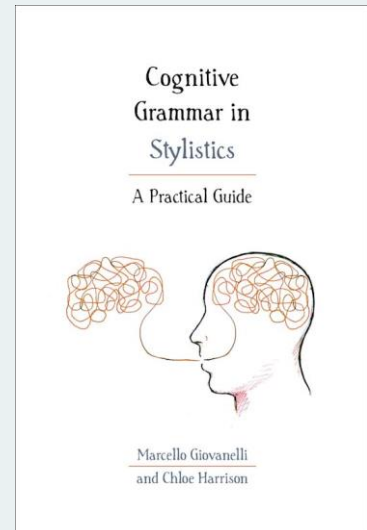
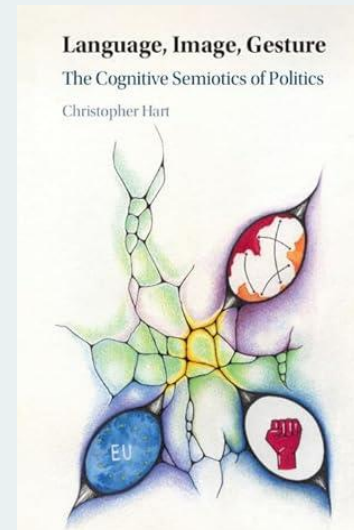
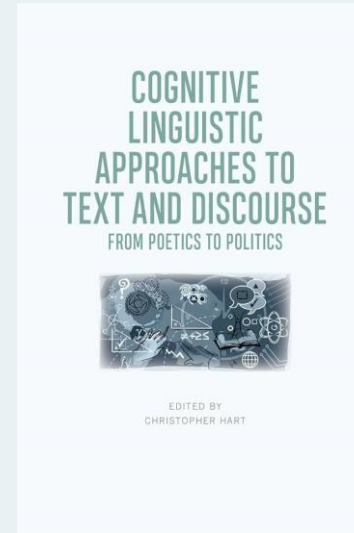
Professor Christopher Hart
Lecture 10: Applications

Overview

- Introduction
- Image Schemas
- Viewpoint
- Grammatical Aspect
- Attention
- Metaphor

Introduction

- Cognitive linguistics applied to language use in various social domains:
 - Education
 - Literature/poetry
 - Politics and Rhetoric
 - Health
 - Environment



Construal and Ideology

- **Ideology** = “systematically organised presentation of reality” (Hodge & Kress 1993: 15) usually in the interests of existing power structures
- Made possible in language through **construal** – “our manifest ability to conceive and portray the same situation in alternate ways” (Langacker 2008: 43)
- Dimensions of construal: image schemas, viewpoint, attention, metaphor
- **Cognitive CDA** (e.g. Hart 2024) considers ideological functions of construal operations in political and media communication

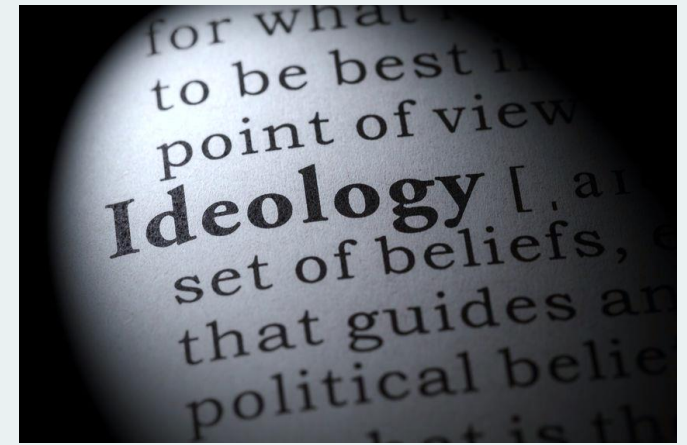


Image Schemas

- Events construed as ACTION, FORCE or MOTION events

- 1) A number of police officers were injured as they came under attack from the protesters (*The Times*, 10 Nov. 2010)
- 2) Pockets of demonstrators pushed forward and were held back by police (*The Independent*, 24 Nov. 2010)
- 3) About 50 riot police moved in just after 5pm as the majority of the protesters began to leave (*The Independent*, 10. Nov. 2010)

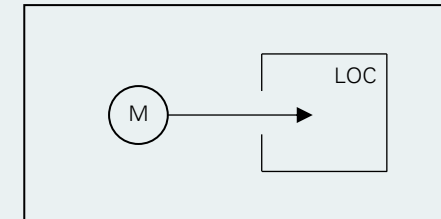
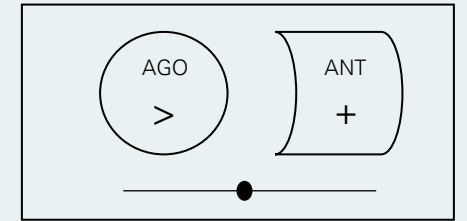
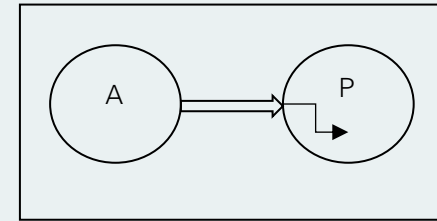


Image Schemas

- In media reports of political protest, e.g. Student Fee Protest 2010, protesters construed as agent in ACTION event while police construed as antagonist in FORCE event or mover in MOTION event (Hart 2013)
- Protest paradigm (Chan & Lee 1984)
- Pattern legitimises police while delegitimising protesters

Protesters activated

	ACTION	FORCE	MOTION	Total
<i>Guardian</i>	6 (0.75)	1 (0.125)	1 (0.125)	8 (0.42)
<i>Independent</i>	7 (0.875)	1 (0.125)	—	8 (0.32)
<i>The Times</i>	7 (0.78)	2 (0.22)	—	9 (0.64)
<i>Telegraph</i>	7 (1)	—	—	7 (0.64)
<i>Express</i>	6 (1)	—	—	6 (0.75)
<i>Mail</i>	5 (0.71)	2 (0.29)	—	7 (0.29)

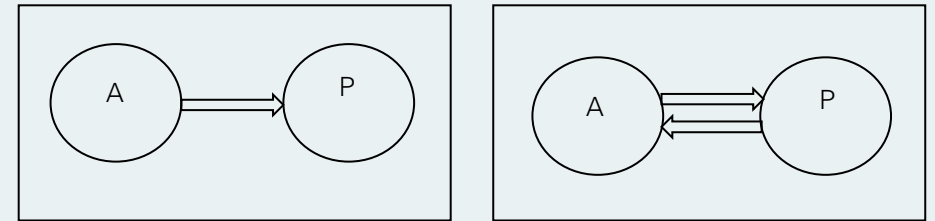
Police activated

	ACTION	FORCE	MOTION	Total
<i>Guardian</i>	6 (0.55)	3 (0.27)	2 (0.18)	11 (0.58)
<i>Independent</i>	3 (0.18)	12 (0.71)	2 (0.12)	17 (0.68)
<i>The Times</i>	1 (0.2)	4 (0.8)	—	5 (0.36)
<i>Telegraph</i>	4 (1)	—	—	4 (0.36)
<i>Express</i>	1 (0.5)	1 (0.5)	—	2 (0.25)
<i>Mail</i>	2 (0.12)	10 (0.59)	5 (0.29)	17 (0.71)

(Hart 2013)

Image Schemas

- Transitive vs. reciprocal verbs indexical of **one-sided** vs. **two-sided** action schemas:
 - 3) A number of police officers were injured after they came under attack from youths, some wearing scarves to hide their faces (*The Telegraph*, 10 Nov. 2010)
 - 4) Activists who had masked their faces with scarves traded punches with police (*Guardian*, 10 Nov. 2010)
- *Guardian*: Two-sided schemas more frequent and account for equal proportions of action events in which police and protesters agents
- All other papers: Two sided schemas less frequent and account for higher proportion of events in which police agents than in which protesters agents



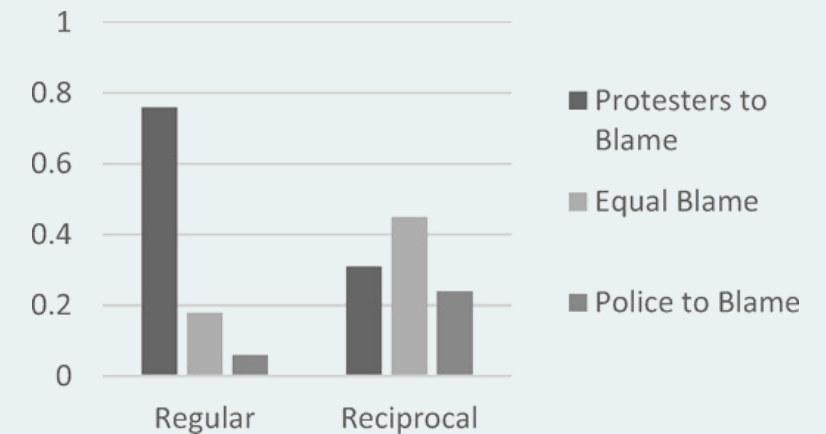
	Reciprocal action schemas		
	% Police action events	% Protestor action events	Total
<i>Guardian</i>	83	83	5
<i>Independent</i>	67	29	2
<i>The Times</i>	100	14	1
<i>Telegraph</i>	75	43	3
<i>Express</i>	100	17	1
<i>Mail</i>	50	20	1

Image Schemas

- Produce ideological effects in **blame assignment** and perception of **aggression**

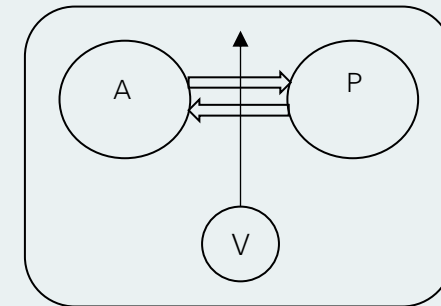
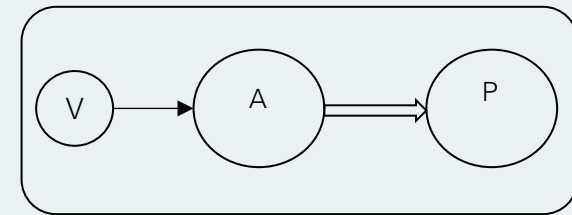
Report 1. A protest against local council policy turned violent yesterday in the city of Southfield. Protesters attacked police officers amid scenes of chaos outside City Hall. The protest later moved to the central square where protesters continued to assault police officers. Police officers used batons to control the crowds, which eventually dispersed around 9 pm. 10 people received treatment for injuries.

Report 3. A protest against local council policy turned violent yesterday in the city of Southfield. Protesters clashed with police officers amid scenes of chaos outside City Hall. The protest later moved to the central square where protesters continued to trade punches with police officers. Police officers used batons to control the crowds, which eventually dispersed around 9 pm. 10 people received treatment for injuries.

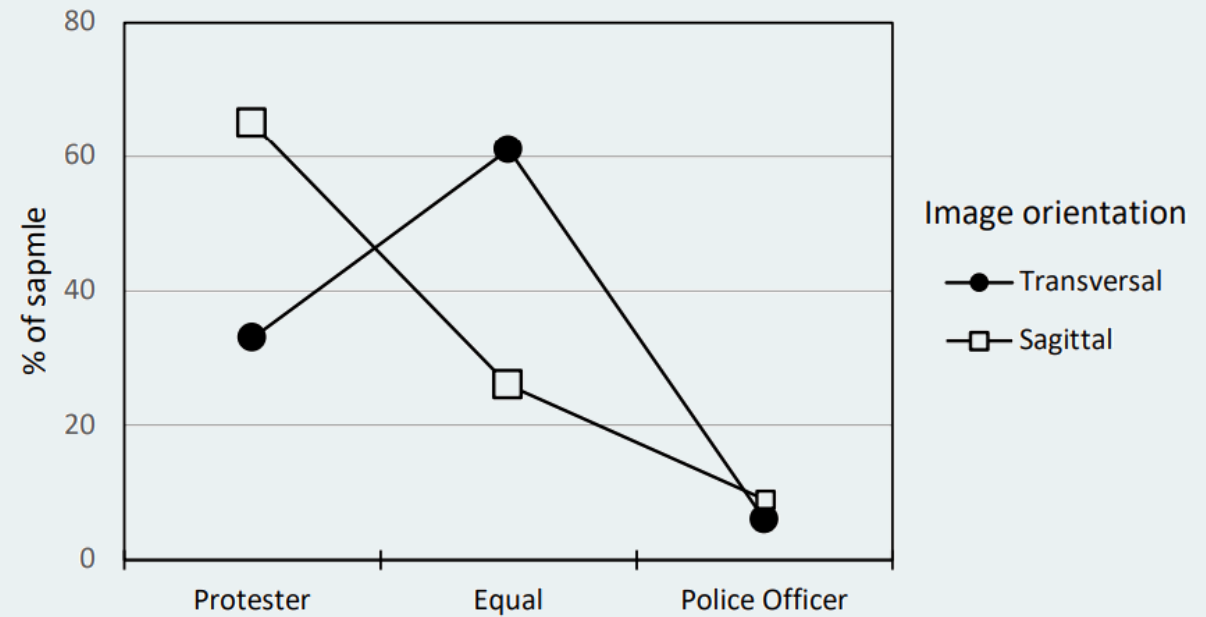
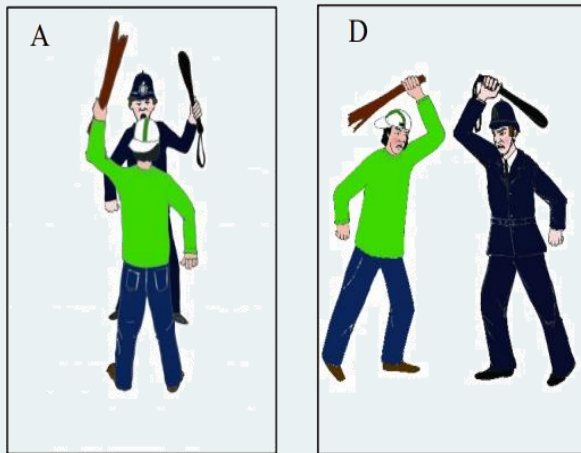


Viewpoint

- **Viewpoint** further dimension of construal included in semantic values of transitive vs. reciprocal constructions
 - **Sagittal** vs. **transversal**
- Active semiotic feature contributing to ideological effects of alternate constructions
- Evidenced where visual analogues produce effects in same direction



Viewpoint



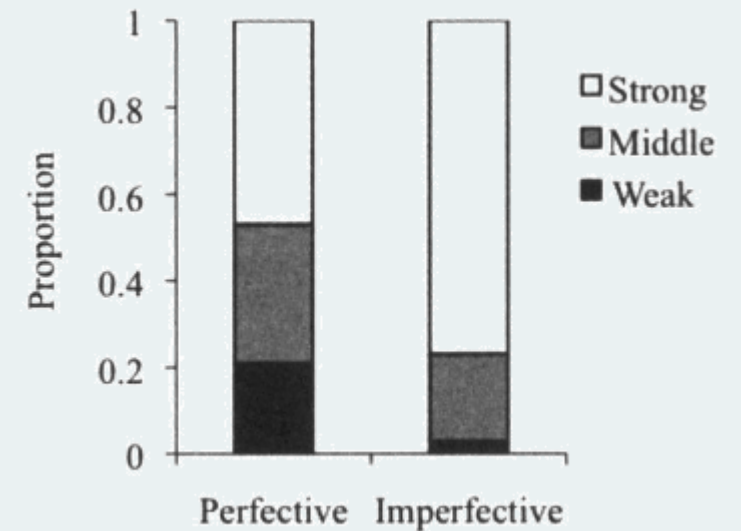
Aspect: From Constructions to Elections

- Grammatical aspect a matter of **boundedness**
 - **Perfective**: complete, bounded
 - **Imperfective (progressive)**: ongoing, unbounded
- Senator's transgressive actions reported in perfective vs. imperfective aspect
- Voters more confident in not re-electing senator when was doing negative actions (e.g. taking hush money, having an affair) than when did negative actions (e.g. took hush money, had an affair)



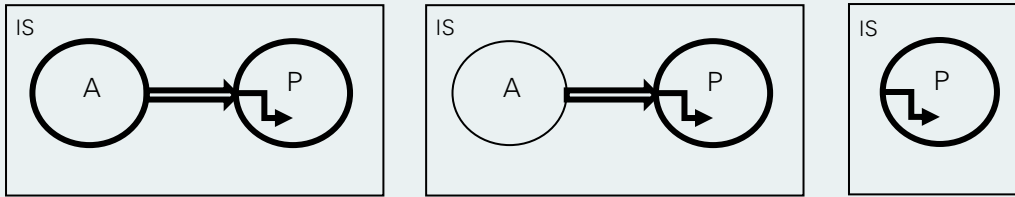
Aspect: From Constructions to Elections

Action valence	Grammatical form	
	Perfective (verb + <i>ed</i>)	Imperfective (<i>was</i> verb + <i>ing</i>)
Negative	Mark Johnson is a Senator in the United States Senate. He is up for reelection. He graduated from the University of Texas, Austin with a degree in political science. Mark's first term as a United States Senator is almost complete. Last year, Mark <u>had an affair</u> with his assistant and <u>took hush money</u> from a prominent constituent. (<i>N</i> = 92)	Mark Johnson is a Senator in the United States Senate. He is up for reelection. He graduated from the University of Texas, Austin with a degree in political science. Mark's first term as a United States Senator is almost complete. Last year, Mark <u>was having an affair</u> with his assistant and <u>was taking hush money</u> from a prominent constituent. (<i>N</i> = 96)
Positive	Mark Johnson is a Senator in the United States Senate. He is up for reelection. He graduated from the University of Texas, Austin with a degree in political science. Mark's first term as a United States Senator is almost complete. Last year, Mark <u>rekindled his relationship</u> with his wife and <u>collected donation money</u> for the American Cancer Society. (<i>N</i> = 85)	Mark Johnson is a Senator in the United States Senate. He is up for reelection. He graduated from the University of Texas, Austin with a degree in political science. Mark's first term as a United States Senator is almost complete. Last year, Mark <u>was rekindling his relationship</u> with his wife and <u>was collecting donation money</u> for the American Cancer Society. (<i>N</i> = 81)



Attention

- Distribution of attention to defocus agency



There is sufficient semiotic evidence in these texts to suggest that their readers might be left with a diminished sense of the violence inflicted and of agency amongst those responsible for it. (Hart 2021: 111)



Metaphor

- Metaphor and framing:

Political and economic ideologies are framed in metaphorical terms. Like all other metaphors, political and economic metaphors can hide aspects of reality. But in the area of politics and economics, metaphors matter more, because they constrain our lives. (Lakoff & Johnson 1980: 236)

Metaphor has consequences for how a particular issue is 'framed' or structured, which aspects are foregrounded and which are backgrounded, what inferences are facilitated, what evaluative and emotional associations triggered, what courses of action seem to be possible and so on. (Semino 2008: 91)



"Tax relief" imposes the additional metaphor that Taxation Is an Affliction, with the entailments that the president is a hero for attempting to remove this affliction and the Democrats are bad guys for opposing him There is of course another way to think about taxes: Taxes are membership fees used to maintain and expand services and the infrastructure. But however true this may be, it is not yet an established frame inscribed in the synapses of our brains. (Lakoff 2004)

Metaphor

- NATION AS PERSON:
 - We are one nation ... We share one heart, one home, and one glorious destiny
 - We will seek friendship and goodwill with the nations of the world
 - In America, we understand that a nation is only living as long as it is striving
- NATION AS BUILDING:
 - We will get our people off of welfare and back to work – rebuilding our country with American hands and American labor.
- POLITICS AS JOURNEY
 - Together, we will determine the course of America and the world for years to come
 - One by one, the factories shuttered and left our shores, with not even a thought about the millions upon millions of American workers left behind.
 - When America is united, America is totally unstoppable
- POLITICS AS COMPETITION
 - America will start winning again, winning like never before
- POLITICS AS LIGHT
 - We do not seek to impose our way of life on anyone, but rather to let it shine as an example for everyone to follow



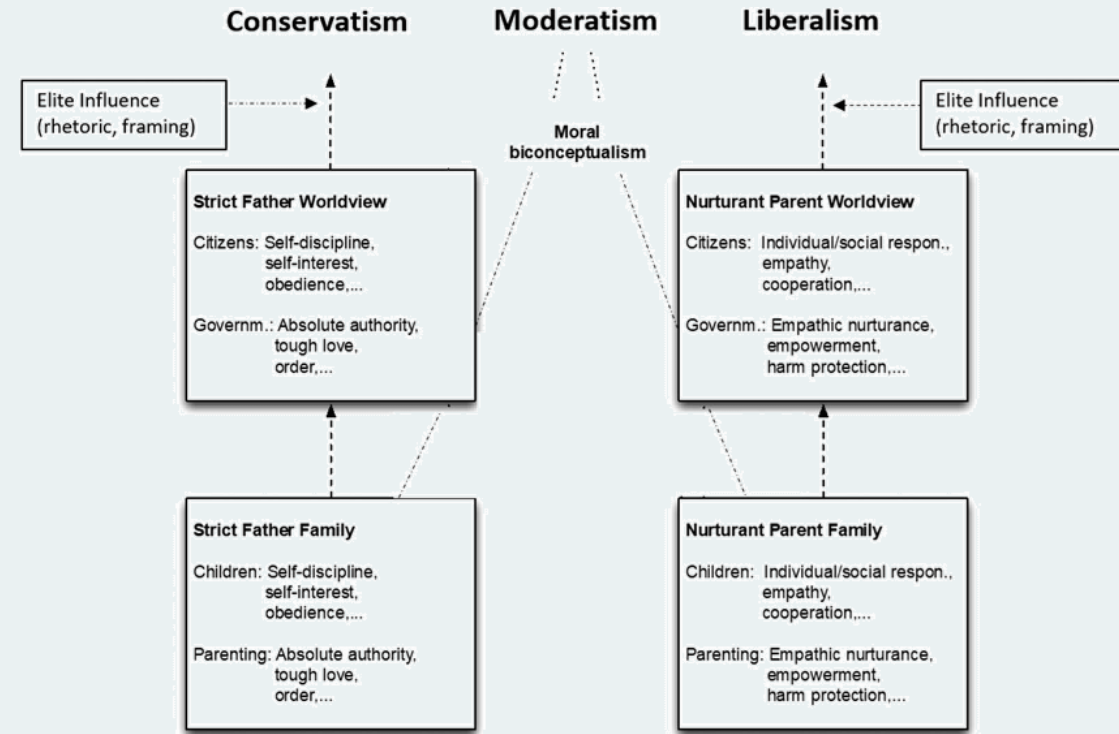
Donald Trump
(Inaugural Address 2017)

Metaphor: Family Values

- NATION AS FAMILY
- Conservative vs. liberal worldviews:
 - STRICT FATHER VS. NURTURANT PARENT

Deeply embedded in conservative and liberal politics are different models of the family. Conservatism, as we shall see, is based on a Strict Father model, while liberalism is centered around a Nurturant Parent model. These two models of the family give rise to different moral systems and different discourse forms, that is, different choices of words and different modes of reasoning.

(Lakoff 1996)

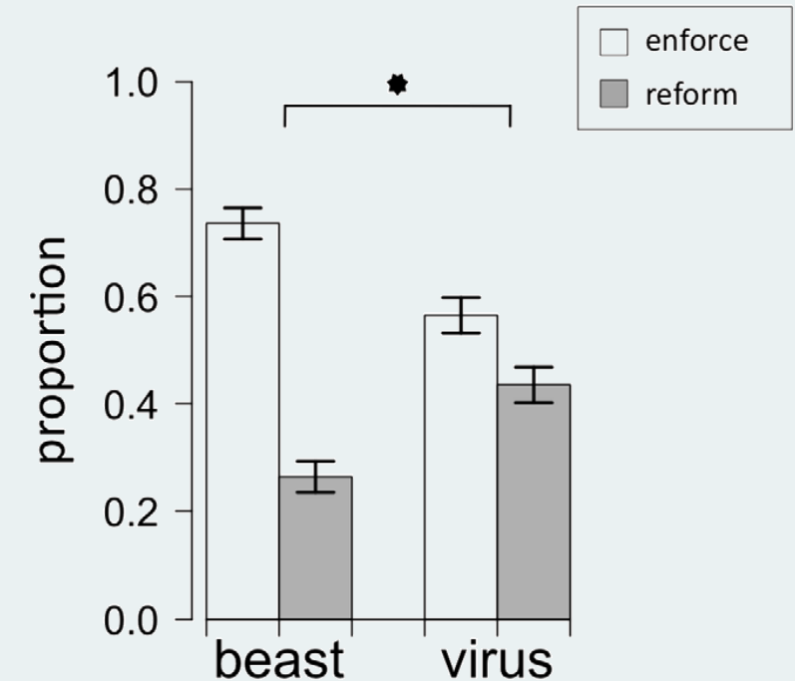


(Feinberg et al. 2019)

Metaphor: Crime and Punishment

Crime is a {wild beast preying on/virus infecting} the city of Addison. The crime rate in the once peaceful city has steadily increased over the past three years. In fact, these days it seems that crime is {lurking in/plaguing} every neighborhood. In 2004, 46,177 crimes were reported compared to more than 55,000 reported in 2007. The rise in violent crime is particularly alarming. In 2004, there were 330 murders in the city, in 2007, there were over 500.

- In your opinion, what does Addison need to do to reduce crime?
- Responses codes as diagnose/treat/inoculate ("reform") vs. capture/enforce/punish ("enforce")



Metaphor: A Nation on Fire

FIRE (METAPHORICAL)

FIRE (LITERAL)



Metaphor: A Nation on Fire

- Global Protests Sparked By George Floyd's Death Spread To Toronto, London And Berlin. (*forbes.com*, 30 May 2020)
- Protests sparked by George Floyd's death are still raging. (*economist.com*, 31 May 2020)
- As riots engulfed the US, crowds gathered in Dublin to protest against the death of Mr Floyd. (*thetimes.co.uk*, 2 Jun. 2020)

Entails Frames	NATURAL PHENOMENON HEAT LIGHT	
Elaborated in Frames	GREAT FIRE OF LONDON	
Metaphorical Frame Relations	ANGER DESIRE CONFLICT	
Core Frame Elements	CAUSE INITIATION ENDURANCE EXTENT SUBSTANCE TRANSMISSION SUSTENANCE CESSATION	<i>Spark</i> <i>Ignite, light, break out, erupt</i> <i>Burn, rage</i> <i>Engulf, consume</i> <i>Fire, flames, smoke</i> <i>Spread</i> <i>Fuel, fan the flames, inflame</i> <i>Extinguish, put out, burn out</i>
Non-Core Frame Elements	TIME PLACE MANNER INSTRUMENT/MEANS MATERIALS	<i>Intensely, violently, rapidly</i> <i>Petrol bomb, fire-hose, water</i> <i>Wood</i>
Associated Scripts/ Scenarios	Emergency Danger Warmth Safety	

Metaphor: A Nation on Fire

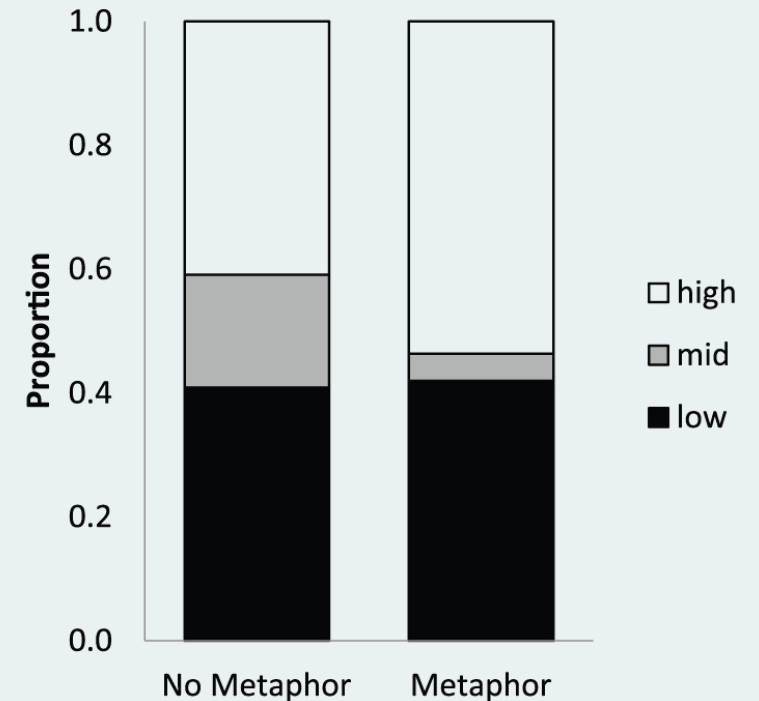
PROTESTS OVERWHELM CITY

Protests have overwhelmed the city of Sudfield. The protests started in the morning but quickly extended throughout the city where they continued to occur all day. Eventually the police used water cannon to disperse the protesters.

PROTESTS ENGULF CITY

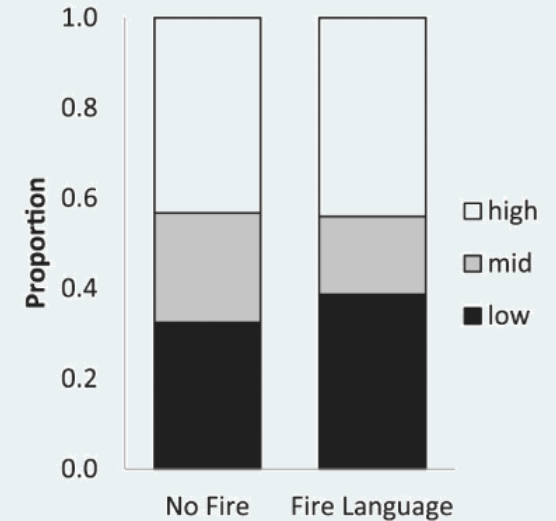
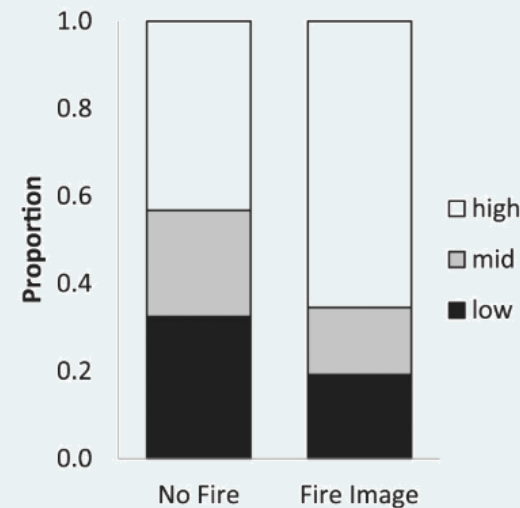
Protests have engulfed the city of Sudfield. The protests ignited in the morning but quickly spread throughout the city where they continued to rage all day. Eventually the police used water cannon to disperse the protesters.

- How logical/justifiable was the decision to use water cannon at the protests in Sudfield?



Metaphor: A Nation on Fire

- In multimodal news texts
 - Images of fire (with literal descriptions) achieve same effects
 - Non-fire images defeat metaphor effect
- Evidence for **simulation** accounts of metaphor (Gibbs 2006)



(Hart 2018)

Metaphor: The Climate Emergency

- Disconnect between scientific consensus and public opinion
- How can separation be addressed?
- Climate action framed as WAR or RACE against climate change
 - 3 samples
 - 3 frames x 2 temporal horizons
- How urgent is it for the US to implement energy reduction programs right away?



Show caption

World losing battle against global warming

DOYLE RICE | USA TODAY

In the battle to combat global warming, the world isn't moving fast enough to stay in the fight.

Metaphor: The Climate Emergency

THE WAR AGAINST CLIMATE CHANGE

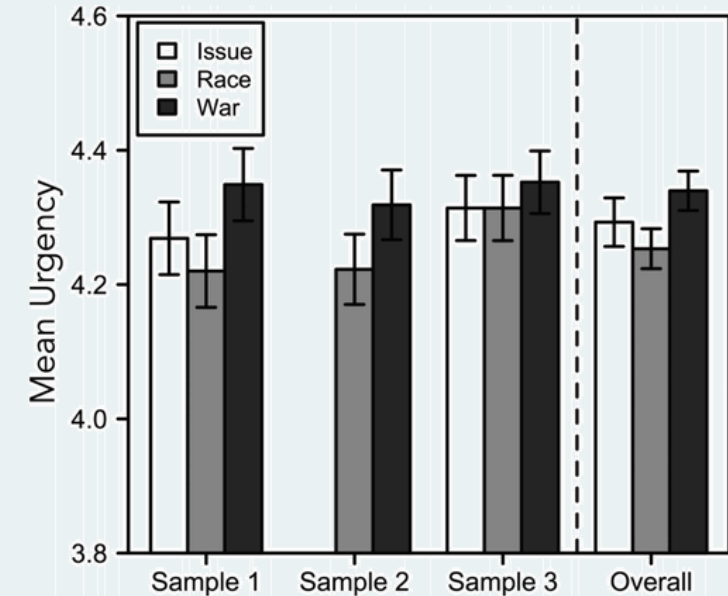
When will Americans start to combat excessive energy use and kill the problems related to air pollution and the destruction of natural resources? The entire country should be recruited to fight this deadly battle. The United States is joining the campaign to reduce its carbon footprint in the next few decades. The US has approved dozens of projects as part of an effort to reduce greenhouse gas emissions by more than 25% by the year [2025/2115]. The projects will leverage scientific expertise and individual engagement to improve the energy efficiency of cars and buildings, reduce personal energy use, and increase the use of renewable energies such as wind and solar. Experts say that if we do not lower emissions in the next [10/100] years, we will experience an increase in extreme weather conditions, more public health problems like a rise in cancer and other diseases, as well as severe economic challenges. This is a war we can't afford to lose!

THE RACE AGAINST CLIMATE CHANGE

When will Americans go after excessive energy use and surge ahead on problems related to air pollution and the destruction of natural resources? The entire country needs to step up to the line and get in front of this challenging problem. The United States is joining the race to reduce its carbon footprint in the next few decades. The US has approved dozens of projects as part of an effort to reduce greenhouse gas emissions by more than 25% by the year [2025/2115]. The projects will leverage scientific expertise and individual engagement to improve the energy efficiency of cars and buildings, reduce personal energy use, and increase the use of renewable energies such as wind and solar. Experts say that if we do not lower emissions in the next [10/100] years, we will experience an increase in extreme weather conditions, more public health problems like a rise in cancer and other diseases, as well as severe economic challenges. This is a race we can't afford to lose!

THE ISSUE OF CLIMATE CHANGE

When will Americans start to address excessive energy use and resolve the problems related to air pollution and the use of natural resources? The entire country needs to direct their efforts to address this important issue. The United States is joining the effort to reduce its carbon footprint in the next few decades. The US has approved dozens of projects as part of an effort to reduce greenhouse gas emissions by more than 25% by the year [2025/2115]. The projects will leverage scientific expertise and individual engagement to improve the energy efficiency of cars and buildings, reduce personal energy use, and increase the use of renewable energies such as wind and solar. Experts say that if we do not lower emissions in the next [10/100] years, we will experience an increase in extreme weather conditions, more public health problems like a rise in cancer and other diseases, as well as severe economic challenges. This is a situation we can't afford to ignore!



War metaphors increase feelings of urgency and risk surrounding the issue of global warming. These findings may be valuable to policymakers, public utility officers, newscasters, and others who seek greater awareness of risk and “buy-in” via public messaging. (Flusberg 2017: 780)

Metaphor: Wars and Wildfires

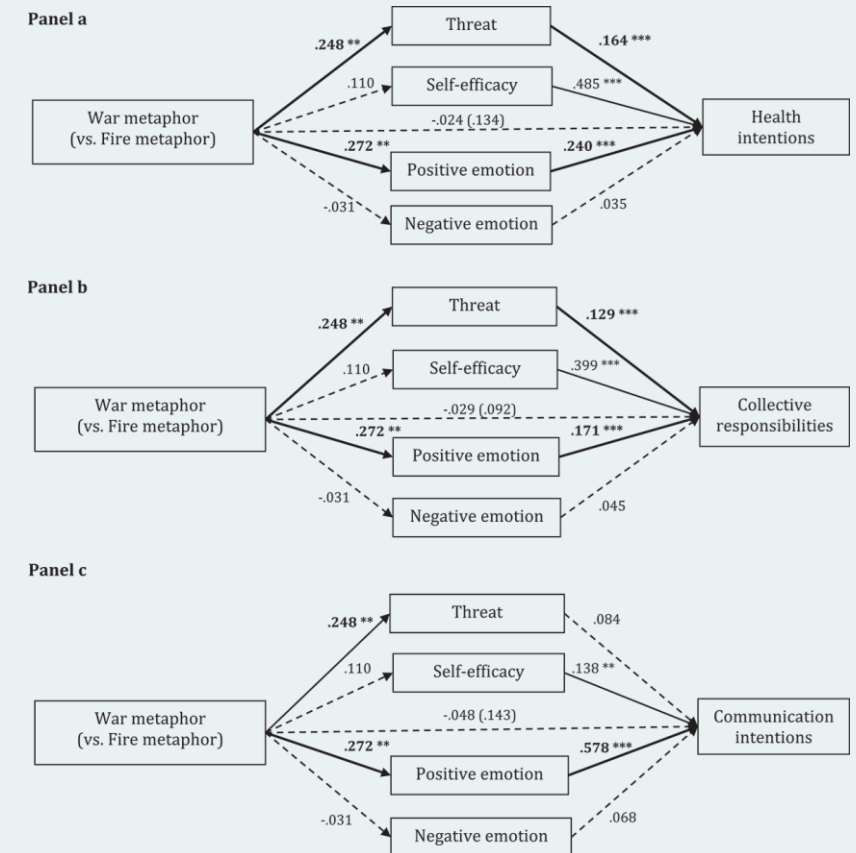
- Covid-19 framed as WAR by governments around world (Filardo-Llamas 2021)
- War metaphors convey gravity of situation and encourage collective action / compliance (Flusberg et al. 2018)
- At same time, potentially problematic in increasing fatalism, contradicting message to stay at home, failing to accurately represent contagion, and falsely implying victory is possible (Hanne 2022; Semino 2021)
- PANDEMIC IS WILDFIRE metaphor may be more apt and more effective strategy in public health crisis communication (Semino 2021)



The measures that I have outlined are unprecedented in peacetime. We will fight this virus with everything we have. We are in a war against an invisible killer and we have to do everything we can to stop it. (Matt Hancock, 16 Mar. 2020)

Metaphor: Wars and Wildfires

- War metaphors more effective than fire metaphor (Tao et al. 2023)
- War metaphors compared to fire metaphor increased threat perception and induced more positive emotions (hopeful, proud, optimistic ...)
- Mediating factors positively associated with intention to adopt pro-health behaviours, sense of collective responsibility, and intention of share/discuss information



Thank you

Selected References

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